NSHD OWL

Data Coverage Report

What is currently available on OWL — and what is still to come.

28,928	~6,072	83%
Variables on OWL	Still to be cleaned (Condor only)	Metadata enhancement complete

Generated 03 November 2026
rmjdish.github.io/OWL/docs/data-coverage/

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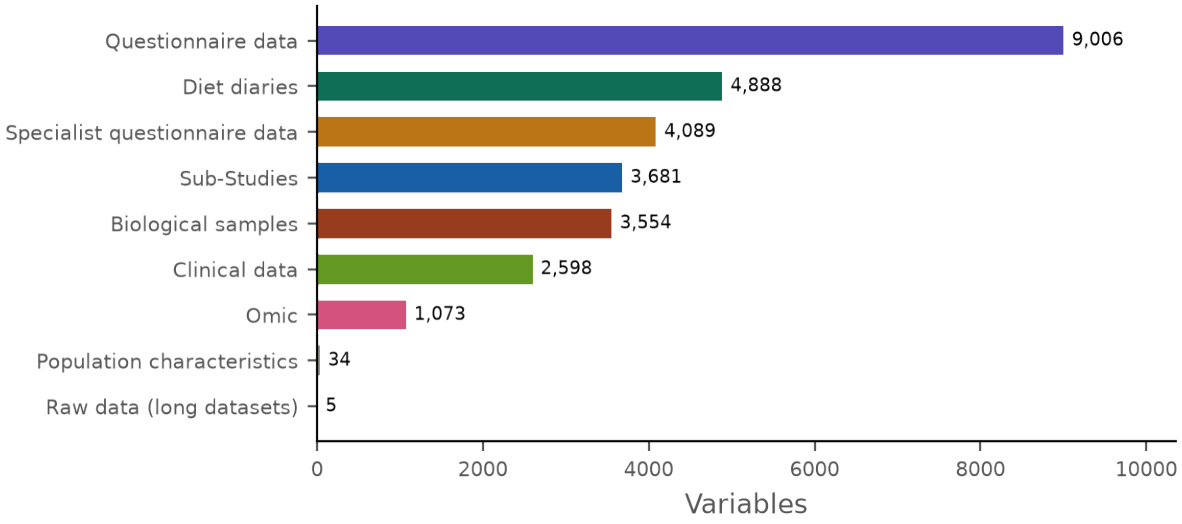
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What is currently available

OWL currently provides access to around **28,928 variables** — those cleaned and enhanced as part of the Metadata Enhancement Project. The full NSHD repository contains approximately 35,000+ variables; the remaining ~6,072 are available on Condor. The 28,928 variables shown here cover 43 collection years spanning 1946 to 2025, across 9 topic areas and 50+ data collection forms.

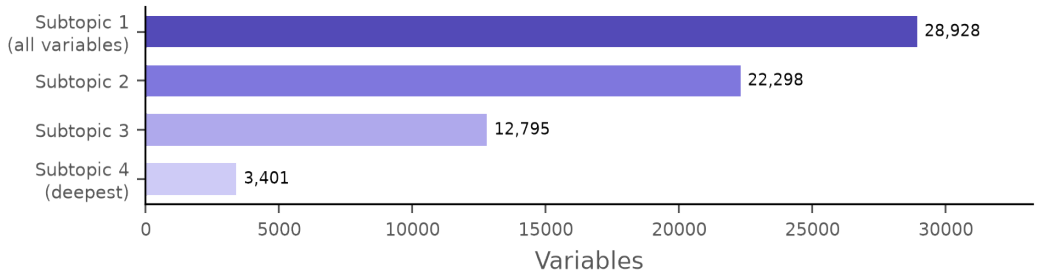
Variables by topic area

Variables are organised into 9 top-level topic areas, shown largest to smallest. Questionnaire data (9,006) and Diet diaries (4,888) make up the largest share.



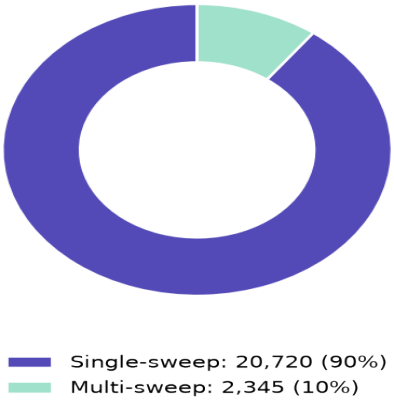
Category classification depth

All 28,928 variables have at least one subtopic level. Deeper classification indicates a more precisely placed variable in the Browse by Category hierarchy.



Single-sweep vs multi-sweep longitudinal Field IDs

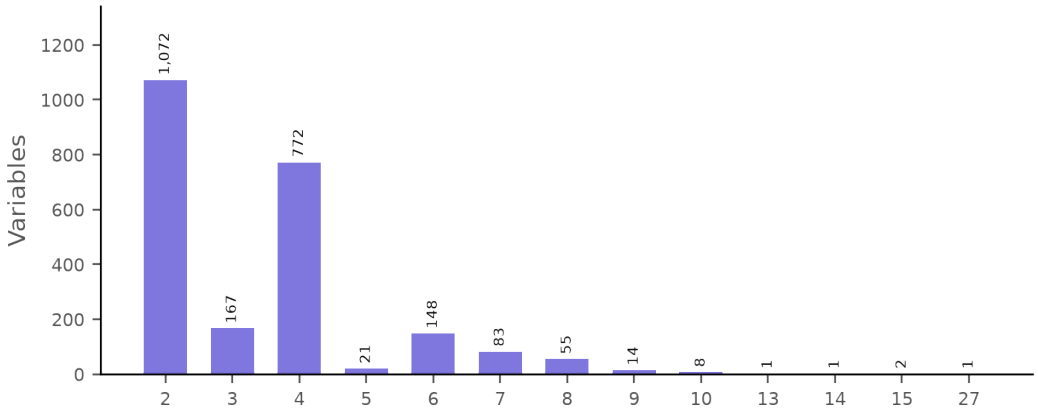
Of the 23,065 unique longitudinal Field IDs, 10% were collected at more than one time point with identical question text and coding.



Note: this chart groups sweeps by distinct collection year per longitudinal Field ID. A small number of longitudinal Field IDs were collected more than once within the same labelled year (e.g. Covid wave 1 and wave 2, both recorded as 2020) and are counted here as single-sweep.

Longitudinal tracking depth

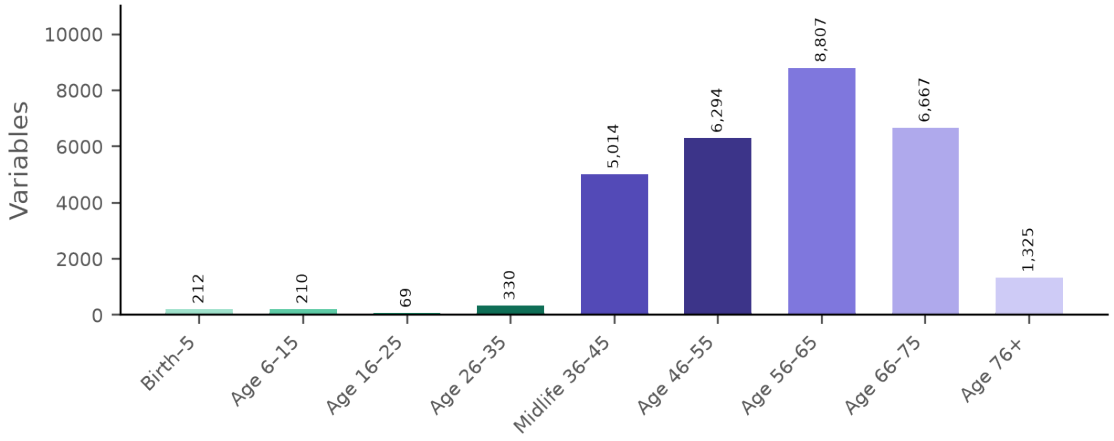
Of 23,065 unique longitudinal Field IDs, 2,345 (10%) have been collected at more than one sweep, some for decades. The most consistently tracked variable is **Interview contact status (recoded) at age 15** (longitudinal Field ID 6200), collected across 27 sweeps spanning 77 years.



Note: these counts only include truly longitudinal variables — those collected with identical question text and coding at every sweep they appear in. Re-worded or re-coded repeats of a question get a separate longitudinal Field ID and are not counted as a repeat sweep here.

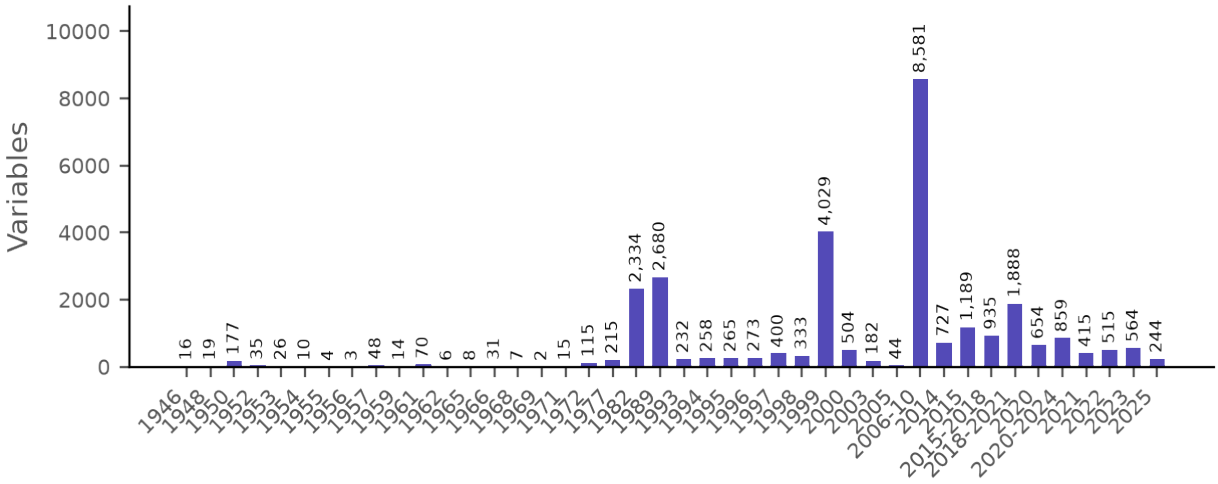
Variables by life stage

The volume of variables reflects the intensity of data collection at each phase of life. The richest coverage is at ages 56–65, corresponding to the major 2006–2010 clinic visit.



Variables by collection year

Variable counts for each collection year or period. The dominant peaks reflect the major intensive data collection sweeps — 2006-10 (8,581), 1999 (4,029), 1989 (2,680), 1982 (2,334).



Variables by data collection form

Variables come from a wide range of data collection instruments, shown largest to smallest ("Other forms" is a catch-all bucket and is always listed last).

Form	Variables
Diet diaries	4,901
Postal questionnaire	4,745

Form	Variables
Nurse Clinic/Home visit	3,573
Blood / Urine / Saliva assays	3,565
Women's Health Questionnaire	2,800
Insight 46 (phases 1 & 2)	2,618
Imaging and devices (Ultrasound, Dicom, Actiheart moniter etc)	1,456
DNA / Genomics	1,071
Covid questionnaires	1,064
Self-completion booklet	867
Myofit sub-study	819
Cognitive tests	165
Doctor's examination	92
Mother's Interview	78
Teacher's questionnaire	19
Other forms	1,095

Note: this table groups variables by the instrument used to collect them (Form), which can differ from their category classification (Subtopic). 40 variables categorised under the Myofit study were collected using another instrument (37 via ACEIII questionnaire; 3 via Blood assays) and are counted under that instrument's row above rather than under "Myofit sub-study". 204 variables categorised under the Insight46 study were collected using another instrument (201 via Ultrasound; 3 via Blood assays) and are counted under that instrument's row above rather than under "Insight 46 (phases 1 & 2)".

UKLLC harmonised datasets

2,867 variables (9.9% of the 28,928 on OWL) have been standardised into a harmonised dataset for cross-cohort comparison via the UK Longitudinal Linkage Collaboration (UKLLC), across 16 distinct harmonised datasets.

Harmonised dataset	Variables
EPIC	566
Emplymnt Hist	483
Household	381
Heart Circ	378
Blood Biochemistry	198
Respiratory	133
Endo Metab	125
BP	120
Econ Circ	120
Smoking	120

Harmonised dataset	Variables
Anthropometry	89
Alcohol	73
Clin disorder	52
Cancer	29
Education	24
APOE genotype	6